Published by a fencing parent with a bot.

The En Garde Gazette
Elite FC
The Elite Fencers Club Weekly

It is better to deserve a rating than to have one.

TUESDAY EDITION
Vol. I — No. 2 · Chatham, N.J. · October 13, 2026

Milinkovic Climbs to 12th at the First ‘Elite’ NAC

From the 49th seed, three straight elimination wins in a 121-fencer Cadet field in Orlando.

Maksim Milinkovic finished 12th of 121 in the Cadet Elite men’s event at the October North American Cup in Orlando, Fla., on Saturday, Oct. 10.

He went 3-3 in pools, then, seeded 49th, won three straight elimination bouts, 15-14, 15-12 and 15-11. His run ended in the round of 16 with a 15-10 loss to the fencer who went on to finish sixth. Andy Zheng won the event.

The day before, Milinkovic went 6-0 in pools in a 233-fencer Division I Challenger field.

It was the first NAC under USA Fencing’s new Elite and Challenger fields; see below for how the split works.

Also fencing for Elite FC in Orlando were Anayaa Sheth, Amina Gore and Penny Young in Cadet Challenger women on Friday, and Penny again in Y14 women on Monday.

Why NAC Fields Now Say ‘Elite’ and ‘Challenger’

The October NAC was the first under USA Fencing’s new structure. Cadet and Division I events with more than 168 entries now split in two: an Elite field capped at 112, filled from the national points list, and a Challenger field for everyone else. In Cadet, Elite spots go to the top 112 Cadet fencers on points; in Division I, to the top 72 Senior, 24 Junior and 16 Cadet fencers. So a fencer can land in Elite in one event and Challenger in another, as Milinkovic did.

The split is set 15 days before the event. Challenger fencers who opt in can move up as Elite spots open, until 5 p.m. local time the night before. The format is a two-year trial, alongside a new points system that took effect Aug. 1. In a Sept. 28 update, USA Fencing added a temporary Elite opt-in for the October and November NACs, apologized for how the carryover of 2025–26 points was communicated, and expanded its points review group, which meets after both NACs.

Overheard on Reddit: Inconceivable?

A fencer asked r/Fencing whether the Princess Bride cliff-top duel is “BS.” The verdict: real names, made-up moves, great show.

The masters are real. Camillo Agrippa (1553), Ridolfo Capo Ferro (1610) and Girard Thibault (1630) left rapier manuals you can still read. Bonetti is most likely Rocco Bonetti, who ran a school in Elizabethan London; no book of his survives.

Commenters agreed the moves on screen aren’t the masters’ techniques. “Thibault does not, in fact, cancel Capo Ferro,” one wrote. Another called it “perfectly fine theatrical fencing.”

The script called for “the greatest sword fight in modern times.” Bob Anderson, who fenced sabre for Great Britain at the 1952 Olympics and doubled for Darth Vader in “Empire” and “Jedi,” choreographed it. Cary Elwes’s 2014 memoir, “As You Wish,” recalls weeks of training before filming and months more on location.

Fact check: *The Cliffs of Insanity are Ireland’s Cliffs of Moher, but the duel was shot on a set.*

CLUB RESULTS

FENCER	EVENT	PLACE
Maksim Milinkovic	Cadet Elite Men (Oct. NAC)	12th of 121
Adela Sullivan	Junior Women (Artdu Open, Oct. 11)	2nd
Christina Jiang	Y12 Mixed (Medeo Youth Challenge #3, Oct. 11)	5th

Also fenced at the NAC: Maksim Milinkovic (Div. I Challenger, 6-0 in pools); Anayaa Sheth, Amina Gore (Cadet Challenger Women); Penny Young (Cadet Challenger Women, Y14 Women).

U.S. Epee Veterans Take Two Silvers in Tbilisi

At the Veteran World Championships in Tbilisi, Georgia, Sean Ameli of the U.S. lost the Veteran 60 men’s epee final 9-8 in overtime to France’s Olivier Guilbert, in a field of 96. Bruce Jugan took silver in Veteran 70 men’s epee, falling 10-5 to Belgium’s Jean Stock in a field of 74. U.S. men also won bronze in both the Veteran and Grand Veteran team epee events. The championships drew 1,273 athletes from 65 nations, per the FIE. Women’s epee runs through Wednesday, Oct. 14, on FencingTV.

New: Wednesday Footwork Class

Elite FC now runs a footwork class on Wednesdays from 6:30 to 7:15 p.m., right after the 5:00 group class. It’s 45 minutes focused on the legs, the part of fencing that sets up everything else.

NEARBY TOURNAMENTS — ELITE FC ENTRIES

MORRIS CUP RYC/RJCC · Suffern, N.Y. · Sat., Oct. 24

TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
8:00 AM	Junior Women	Amina Gore, Olivia Hayes
8:00 AM	Y12 Men	Kian Jaising, Joshua Jeong, Remy Ng
12:30 PM	Cadet Men	Pablo Aguirre, Connor Anderson, Nico Ng, Caden Wu
3:00 PM	Y14 Women	Stella Kuo, Mila Siu

ULTIMATE CUP RJCC · Hillsborough, N.J. · Oct. 31–Nov. 1

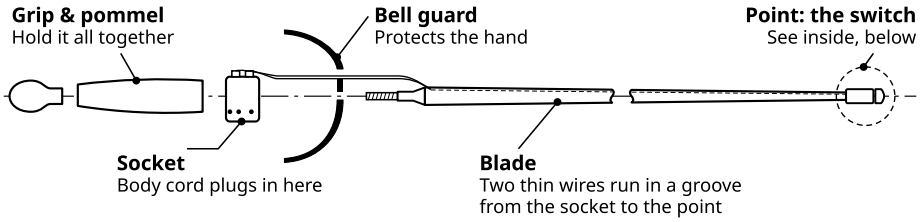
DAY	EVENT	ELITE FC
Sat 10/31	Junior Women	Olivia Hayes, Adela Sullivan
Sat 10/31	Cadet Men	Maksim Milinkovic, Caden Wu
Sun 11/1	Junior Men	Pablo Aguirre, Dieko Johnson, Maksim Milinkovic, Nico Ng
Sun 11/1	Cadet Women	Olivia Hayes, Lillian Liu, Adela Sullivan, Penny Young

MORRIS CUP RYC/RJCC · Suffern, N.Y. · Sun., Oct. 25

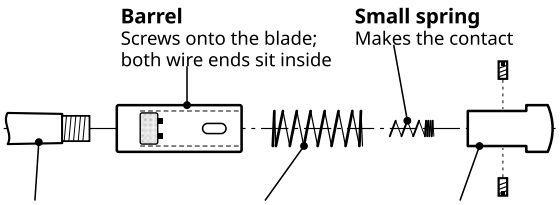
TIME	EVENT	ELITE FC
8:00 AM	Cadet Women	Amina Gore, Olivia Hayes, Adela Sullivan, Penny Young
8:00 AM	Junior Men	Pablo Aguirre, Nico Ng
10:00 AM	Y8 Women	Madeline Siu
10:30 AM	Y12 Women	Christina Jiang, Stella Kuo, Mila Siu
1:30 PM	Y14 Men	Connor Anderson, Noah Gore, Kian Jaising, Remy Ng, Ash Shah-Mirani
3:30 PM	Y10 Men	Bryce Cheng, Joshua Jeong, Maximus Siu

Morris Cup is at Rockland Community College's Eugene Levy Field House: 19 Elite FC fencers, 29 entries. Ultimate Cup is at Iron Peak Sports & Events in Hillsborough: nine Elite FC fencers, 12 entries.

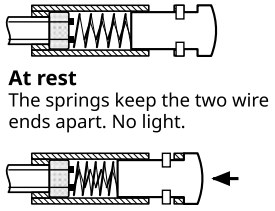
THE WEAPON



INSIDE THE POINT



HOW A TOUCH SCORES



The Weapon: an epee taken apart, grip to tip, and what happens inside the point when a touch scores.

EPEE ON SCREEN

DATES	EVENT	WATCH
Oct. 12–14	Veteran Worlds, women (Tbilisi)	FencingTV
Oct. 15–18	Senior World Cup, men + women (Casablanca)	FencingTV
Oct. 22–25	Junior/Cadet World Cup (San José, Costa Rica)	No stream listed
Nov. 12–15	Senior World Cups: Berne (men), Wuxi (women)	FencingTV

From the FIE calendar, which lists no start times or prices.

DEADLINES

DATE	WHAT CLOSES
Mon 10/19	Ultimate Cup: regular-fee entry (extended from Oct. 12)
Thu 10/22	Morris Cup: last day to enter (late, triple fees)
Thu 10/29	Ultimate Cup: last day to enter (late, triple fees)

All by 11:59 p.m. Pacific (2:59 a.m. Eastern the next day), from the USA Fencing tournament pages.

Overheard on Reddit: First Tournament? The Internet Has Notes

A nervous first-timer, the only one from the home club competing, asked r/Fencing what etiquette to know. The forum delivered.

Check your score sheet before you sign it, an epee fencer urged, in capital letters. Signing says you agree with the scores, and once the review period closes, they stand.

Don't stop until the referee calls "Halt," another commenter warned. Pulling up to look back at the scoring box can cost you, since a touch that lands before "Halt" still counts.

An epee referee suggested hanging your spare body cord on your spare weapon (the rules require a spare of each) and handing the reel connector to the next fencer instead of letting it zip back into the reel.

Another epee fencer's motto: "You have no friends on strip." Rivals there, friends off it.

The consensus, in one commenter's words: "Don't argue, be polite, and have fun."